

A close-up photograph of a baby lying on its back. An adult's hands are gently holding the baby's hands, one in each. The baby's face is visible in the lower right, looking up. The background is a soft, out-of-focus light color.

Help him discover his hands

Hold your baby's hands in yours, or let him grip your fingers, and move them gently from side-to-side to soothing music. He'll watch his hands—and you—as he begins to discover this part of his body, even though he doesn't yet realize his hands are connected to his body.



Give your baby a hand massage

Gently open up your baby's hands and massage his palms using a plant-based or edible oil such as olive oil. (For the best oil to use, ask your pediatrician, but avoid oils likely to cause a reaction such as peanut, paraffin, sesame, and essential oils.)